

英検2級 リーディング問題

2023年度 第2回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (1) *A:* What do you think of your new high school, Paula?
B: It's great, Mr. Morgan. I like it better than my (1) school.
1 neutral 2 exact 3 previous 4 appropriate
- (2) Having a part-time job is good for Kaoru because she needs extra money to spend, but one (2) is that she cannot go out with her friends on weekends.
1 structure 2 baggage 3 disadvantage 4 lecture
- (3) After a series of financial scandals, many people began to demand that the government make rules to (3) banks more strictly.
1 regulate 2 reproduce 3 irritate 4 impress
- (4) David felt the job interview had gone badly, so he thought that the letter from the company would be a (4). He was surprised to find he had actually got the job.
1 symptom 2 rejection 3 biography 4 contribution

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q10

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) When the police found the escaped criminal hiding in an old warehouse, they approached him (5).
1 partially 2 temporarily 3 regionally 4 cautiously
- (6) Chris (6) his invitation to the barbecue party to friends, neighbors, and relatives. He wanted as many people as possible to come.
1 removed 2 extended 3 compared 4 proved
- (7) The rock band's (7) only lasted a few months. After radio stations stopped playing the band's songs, people soon forgot about it.
1 shade 2 area 3 fame 4 origin
- (8) Whenever Keith goes traveling, he (8) his luggage very carefully. He once had a bag stolen on a train, so he always keeps his things where he can see them.
1 guards 2 carves 3 divorces 4 accelerates
- (9) Louis has worked at the same company since he graduated from college. This year, after four (9) of working there, he is going to retire.
1 jails 2 decades 3 principles 4 societies
- (10) Kate took a walk by the sea yesterday. Some of the rocks were wet and slippery, so she often had to (10) herself to avoid falling into the water.
1 punish 2 defeat 3 filter 4 steady

大問1 語彙・文法 Q11-Q15

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (11) Olivia worked for her father for eight years and eventually (11) his business. She ran the company very successfully and even opened a branch overseas.
- 1 wrote up 2 took over 3 kept off 4 fell through
- (12) **A:** Well, tomorrow our vacation (12) an end, and we have to fly back home.
B: I know. I don't want to leave. I wish we could stay here longer.
- 1 goes for 2 brings up 3 takes out 4 comes to
- (13) Gary has been having problems with his knees (13) for several months. Yesterday, they were really painful. They are better today, but he has decided to see his doctor anyway.
- 1 on and off 2 up and down 3 side by side 4 one by one
- (14) A storm caused the power to go off in Greenville yesterday. Residents had to (14) electricity for two hours before the supply was restored.
- 1 drop by 2 come across 3 go against 4 do without
- (15) **A:** Where's Gerald? He should have been here half an hour ago.
B: That's (15) him. I don't think he ever arrives on time.
- 1 typical of 2 inferior to 3 grateful for 4 patient with

大問1 語彙・文法 Q16-Q20

次の(1)から(20)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(16) Ms. Williams said that her students could have one more week to finish their history assignments, but anyone who (16) their work late would be in trouble.

- 1 brought down 2 brought out 3 turned in 4 turned on

(17) Because Angela's family was (17), she did not have to worry about the cost of going to university.

- 1 close up 2 next up 3 far off 4 well off

(18) Eisuke is the fastest runner at his school. He is sure (18) the 100-meter race at the sports festival.

- 1 to win 2 win 3 will win 4 won

(19) **A:** Brian, you (19) put so much salt on your food. Eating too much salt can be bad for you.
B: OK, Mom. I won't.

- 1 to not ought 2 not ought to 3 ought not to 4 to ought not

(20) Miranda screamed for joy (20) moment she heard that she had got into Budgeforth College.

- 1 the 2 on 3 at 4 a

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q21-Q23

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(21)から(26)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Doggerland

Since the 1930s, fishermen have occasionally found ancient objects made from stone or bone in their nets when fishing in the sea between Britain and northern Europe. Many of these objects were made around 9,000 years ago. Historians used to believe this area was underwater at that time, like it is now. There was also little evidence that ancient Europeans regularly traveled on the sea. (21), experts had difficulty explaining how these man-made objects had ended up at the bottom of the ocean.

The only possible explanation was that sea levels must have been much lower in the past. In fact, research shows that Britain did not become an island until about 8,000 years ago. Before that, people (22) the European continent. The huge piece of land that once connected Britain and the European continent has been given the name Doggerland. As the last ice age ended, sea levels rose. Britain was separated from the rest of Europe when most of Doggerland was covered by the sea. By about 7,000 years ago, sea levels had risen further and covered Doggerland completely.

Researchers want to learn more about the people who lived in Doggerland. They have created 3D maps from data that has been collected by companies searching for oil at the bottom of the sea. The researchers are using these maps to choose sites where humans probably lived. At one of these sites, the researchers (23). As a result, they are hopeful that they will continue to make discoveries about the culture and lifestyles of the people of Doggerland.

(21)

- 1 What is more 2 Likewise 3 Therefore 4 Equally

(22)

- 1 made objects on 2 rarely visited 3 had heard stories about 4 could walk to it from

(23)

- 1 used a robot to look for oil 2 found an ancient stone tool 3 built a small museum 4 noticed some recent changes

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q24-Q26

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(21)から(26)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

The Science of False Starts

A shot is fired at the beginning of a running race to tell athletes to start moving. If one of the athletes moves before the shot is fired, it is known as a "false start," and the athlete is removed from the race. Interestingly, if an athlete moves before 0.1 seconds have passed after the shot is fired, this is also a false start. Athletics organizations argue that no human can (24). They say that such an athlete must have been guessing when the shot would be fired rather than waiting to hear it.

To learn more about false starts, scientists have carried out experiments on human response times. One experiment in the 1990s found that athletes responded to the sound of the shot after 0.12 seconds (25). Some were slightly quicker, while others were slightly slower. However, the athletes who took part in this experiment were amateurs. A more recent experiment showed that some professional athletes might be able to respond in just 0.08 seconds. Both studies, however, involved a small number of athletes.

Some people think that the false start rule is too strict. In some other sports and track-and-field events, athletes (26) if they break a rule. For example, in the long jump, if an athlete's foot goes over the line on their first attempt, the athlete still has two more opportunities to try. Some people suggest that instead of removing athletes who make false starts, their start position should be moved back a few meters, and this would make the races fair for everyone.

(24)

- 1 react so quickly 2 jump so high 3 hear such sounds 4 lift such weights

(25)

- 1 so far 2 by then 3 on average 4 in total

(26)

- 1 have extra chances 2 must pay money 3 can watch a video replay 4 return their medals

大問3A Story time

メールを読み、次ページのQ27-Q29に答えなさい。

From: Melissa Simmons
To: Library staff
Date: October 8
Subject: Story time

One of my goals as the director of Wigby Public Library is to make it a popular place for families. Reading is important for everyone, especially children. If parents and children read books together, they will share happy memories and build better relationships. Also, reading is a great way for parents to help with their children's education. Our library can play a surprisingly important role in making Wigby an even smarter and more caring town!

With this in mind, I have decided to start a weekly storytelling session for children and parents, and I need your help to make it fun. Of course, I want your suggestions for stories. I also need someone to make posters to advertise the sessions and someone to look for items that the person telling the story can use to make the stories more fun. Finally, I think we should take turns telling the stories.

Please let me know if there is something you would really like to do for these sessions. If you have any ideas that could help make them better, I would like to hear them, too. Also, if you have any ideas that will encourage more families to come to the library, please feel free to tell me about them. You can either send me an e-mail or come to my office to talk to me in person.

大問3A Story time

前ページのメールを読み、Q27-Q29に答えなさい。

(27) According to Melissa, one way that reading can help families is by

- 1 giving children a chance to explain their goals to their parents.
- 2 allowing parents and children to develop better connections.
- 3 improving parents' chances of getting well-paid jobs.
- 4 reducing the amount of time that children spend watching TV.

(28) What is one thing that Melissa asks library staff to do?

- 1 Let her know if they are friends with any writers.
- 2 Help her to move items to make space for an event.
- 3 Write a story about a group of young children.
- 4 Create notices that tell people about an activity.

(29) Why does Melissa invite staff members to her office?

- 1 To have a meeting to review the duties of staff members.
- 2 To tell her how to make the library more attractive to families.
- 3 She is too busy to be able to go and speak to them.
- 4 She wants to get to know each staff member much better.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ30-Q33に答えなさい。

Purple Straw Wheat

Wheat is an important crop in the United States, and its seeds are used for making bread, pasta, and other foods. It has been the country's main food grain since the 18th century. Wheat production in the United States, however, has faced challenges throughout its history. During the late 18th century, many types of wheat were attacked by diseases and insects that came from Europe. One type of wheat called purple straw wheat, though, was able to resist these dangers, and for a long time, it was the best choice for many farmers to plant.

Purple straw wheat seeds can be used to make whiskey or produce soft and delicious flour that is good for making cakes and bread. It has been grown since the 18th century, especially in the southern United States. What made purple straw wheat particularly important was its ability to survive winter weather. Unlike other types, purple straw wheat could be planted in late autumn and harvested in early spring. This meant that it avoided summer diseases and insects. As a result, purple straw wheat continued to be widely grown until the mid-20th century.

In the 1960s, scientists developed new types of wheat by mixing the genes of existing ones. These new types produced more seeds per plant and were better able to resist diseases. By using modern farming technology, chemicals that kill insects, and these new types of wheat, farmers could produce large quantities of wheat seeds more cheaply than before. Although flour from purple straw wheat is tastier and healthier, this type of wheat almost completely went out of use.

Some researchers wanted to bring back purple straw wheat. However, its seeds were not easy to obtain because there were only a few sources. The researchers finally managed to get a few grams of purple straw wheat seeds and planted them at Clemson University in South Carolina. They have been gradually increasing the amount of wheat that they can produce, although it is still not enough to make and sell flour. Many chefs, bakers, and whiskey makers are looking forward to being able to use purple straw wheat in their products.

大問3B 長文設問 Q30-Q33

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (30) What happened in the late 18th century in the United States?
- 1 Farmers developed a type of wheat that produced better flour.
 - 2 Diseases and insects that affected wheat plants arrived from overseas.
 - 3 A lack of wheat meant that it had to be imported from Europe.
 - 4 People started to use grains other than wheat to make bread.
-
- (31) What was one reason that purple straw wheat was better than other types of wheat?
- 1 It could be grown during the coldest part of the year.
 - 2 It could be used to make new kinds of foods and drinks.
 - 3 It could survive the hot summers in the southern United States.
 - 4 It could grow in fields that had low-quality soil.
-
- (32) Why did people stop growing purple straw wheat in the 20th century?
- 1 It was not suitable for use with modern farming technology.
 - 2 Scientists created types of wheat that gave greater numbers of seeds.
 - 3 People wanted to buy flour that tasted better and was healthier.
 - 4 Chemicals that kill insects destroyed many purple straw wheat plants.
-
- (33) Researchers who have been growing purple straw wheat
- 1 could only get a small amount of purple straw wheat seeds.
 - 2 tested it in several different locations in the United States.
 - 3 offered flour made from the wheat to chefs, bakers, and whiskey makers.
 - 4 were surprised at how quickly they were able to produce enough to sell.
-

大問3C 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ34-Q38に答えなさい。

Venice's Books

During the Middle Ages, the Italian city of Venice was famous for international trade. Not only was the city's location important, but also there were fewer laws controlling people's behavior than in other parts of Europe. This freedom attracted writers, artists, and craftspeople to the city. Following the invention of printing machines in the 15th century, these people combined their abilities to make Venice the center of the printing and bookmaking industry in Europe. This tradition of making high-quality books by hand survives in the city to this day.

Paolo Olbi is helping to keep this tradition alive. He makes use of techniques that have existed for centuries to produce beautiful books, diaries, and photo albums. The paper inside them is cut by hand, and their covers are made of hand-printed paper, leather, wood, and even a kind of Italian glass called Murano. When Olbi began learning his craft in 1962, there were about 20 bookstores in Venice that made handmade books. Now, though, Olbi's store is one of only three such places that remain.

One of Olbi's heroes is a man called Aldus Manutius. Manutius founded a printing company in 1494 that became one of the most famous printing companies in Venice. Until the late 15th century, books were large, heavy, and very expensive. They were mostly about religion and law. Manutius developed techniques to produce smaller, lighter, and cheaper books. Moreover, he printed novels and books about art and philosophy. These developments made books more popular and easier to buy for ordinary people.

Olbi has a picture of Manutius on the wall of his store. Like Manutius, he loves books and believes they should be beautiful. Over the years, Olbi has taught his skills to many people. In 2018, a former student invited Olbi to display his books at an exhibition of handmade objects. This gave Olbi a chance to get more people interested in traditional bookmaking. Olbi wants to expand his store into a cultural center where tourists can see how he makes books and young people can learn his techniques. By doing so, he hopes to prevent the tradition of bookmaking in Venice from being lost.

大問3C 長文設問 Q34-Q38

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(34) What is one reason that writers, artists, and craftspeople were attracted to Venice?

- 1 They could get part-time jobs in the bookmaking industry.
- 2 They could sell their work at higher prices in the city.
- 3 The city's location provided inspiration for their work.
- 4 The city allowed people to live more freely than other places.

(35) Paolo Olbi is a bookmaker who

- 1 uses traditional methods to make his products.
- 2 owns about 20 bookstores in the city of Venice.
- 3 has developed a new technique for printing on glass.
- 4 tries to use recycled materials to produce books.

(36) Aldus Manutius helped to increase the popularity of books by

- 1 opening schools in Venice where people could learn to read.
- 2 printing more and more books about topics such as religion and law.
- 3 writing a series of novels about artists and philosophers in Venice.
- 4 finding ways to reduce the size, weight, and prices of books.

(37) What is one thing that Olbi would like to do?

- 1 Find a picture of Manutius that was lost many years ago.
- 2 Meet his former students to find out what they have been doing.
- 3 Create a place where more people can learn about bookmaking.
- 4 Write a book about the life and achievements of Manutius.

(38) Which of the following statements is true?

- 1 One of the most famous printing companies in Venice was established in 1494.
- 2 The number of stores in Venice making handmade books has increased since 1962.
- 3 Olbi holds an annual exhibition in Venice to display the work of his students.
- 4 Laws to stop international trade were introduced in Venice in the Middle Ages.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。



Q01-Q13	Q14-Q26	Q27-Q38
Q013 on and off 1	Q26 have extra chances 1	Q38 One of the most famous printing companies in Venice was established in 1494. 1
Q12 comes to 4	Q25 on average 3	Q37 Create a place where more people can learn about bookmaking. 3
Q11 took over 2	Q24 react so quickly 1	Q36 finding ways to reduce the size, weight, and prices of books. 4
Q10 steady 4	Q23 found an ancient stone tool 2	Q35 uses traditional methods to make his products. 1
Q09 decades 2	Q22 could walk to it from 4	Q34 The city allowed people to live more freely than other places. 4
Q08 guards 1	Q21 Therefore 3	Q33 could only get a small amount of purple straw wheat seeds. 1
Q07 fame 3	Q20 the 1	Q32 Scientists created types of wheat that gave greater numbers of seeds. 2
Q06 extended 2	Q19 ought not to 3	Q31 It could be grown during the coldest part of the year. 1
Q05 cautiously 4	Q18 to win 1	Q30 Diseases and insects that affected wheat plants arrived from overseas. 2
Q04 rejection 2	Q17 well off 4	Q29 To tell her how to make the library more attractive to families. 2
Q03 regulate 1	Q16 turned in 3	Q28 Create notices that tell people about an activity. 4
Q02 disadvantage 3	Q15 typical of 1	Q27 allowing parents and children to develop better connections. 2
Q01 previous 3	Q14 do without 4	

学習記録

得点

/ 38

やり直す問題

メモ